



Trying hard to not communicate.. Les amants, by Magritte

Thus, every part of the product, service or system is a communication, as it's a part of the user's experience. "Every part" literally refers to everything – from the font used on a button label to the number of clicks it takes to get to some particular content – all of this sends a message. If you don't explicitly know the message being sent, consider each design element in the context of the five factors discussed earlier to know what's being communicated.

Now that we know this principle, we must apply it. The next step is asking ourselves, for each element: is it communicating the *intended* message or a contradictory message? Enforcing this principle vigorously allows us to refine every little detail, even the minutiae that go unseen or unsaid, that ultimately contribute to crafting the whole User Experience.

Simple? Yes, but also fundamental.

The Consistency Principle

A successful UX design involves consistency across a latitude of multiple levels, keeping in step with both, *de jure* and *de facto* standards. The evil twin of consistency is confusion, and as UX designers, we never invite confu-